

Susie always thought her husband Sam was wealthy. They met in Paris the summer after Susie graduated from college. Her parents had paid for this trip as a graduation gift to their daughter. She first saw Sam while visiting the Louvre museum. Sam said that he had just popped over for the weekend from New York, where he lived. Susie, age twenty-one, had just accepted an internship in New York City and didn't know anyone there, so she was happy to exchange phone numbers. After she moved to New York City, Sam asked her out on their first date.

While they were dating, Sam wined and dined her. He brought her to fancy, expensive restaurants and every week sent exotic flowers to her office. All the other women she worked with were jealous. Sam always dressed only in designer suits and had a foreign luxury car.

Because Susie had an entry-level salary, she had to live with three other roommates just to make ends meet. She lived on a tight budget, having just started her career. Even though Sam was the same age, she was sure he made much more money than her. She never saw him clipping coupons or shopping at discount stores. He must be making excellent money to be able to afford all these things, she thought.

It never occurred to Susie that appearances could be deceiving. In reality, all of these things were being paid for by incurring debt. One night while out at dinner, Sam's credit card was declined. He then pulled another card out of his wallet to pay, which also was not approved. At this point, Susie glanced at Sam's wallet as he searched for another credit card and she saw that his bulging wallet contained at least twenty different credit cards. Being a conservative spender and owning only one credit card herself, she started to panic. "How many credit cards do you have?" she demanded. Sam responded that he didn't know. Susie then grabbed his wallet and started to count them. She counted twenty-two. "How

